This week showed me that there are six main ways to connect AI, from simple to complex integration. They go from using AI as a function, all the way up to agents that take actions on their own. The biggest lesson to me was “learn patterns, not products”. Tools change every few months. What lasts is knowing how data moves from input to the AI step, to the output. I also learned that higher is not always better. Each step up adds cost, complexity, and risk. Most good MVPs only need the first three levels.

My investing app sits at level five; a custom app called a model. The “AI, rules, or people” slide helped me explain my design. In my app, rules handle the math, like stock prices and the Vantage Score. The AI handles the part rules cannot do well, which is explaining those numbers in plain English. People make the final call. The app explains, but it never tells users what to buy.

The demo on prompt injection stuck with me. Hidden text on a web page can tell an AI what to do. My app shows news headlines, so I need to think about what happens if that text reaches my assistant. Filling out the permissions card helped. My assistant can only read data. It cannot trade or change anything. I also need to keep checking its answers against the real data, since a wrong explanation could mislead a beginner.

I used Claude to organize my notes from the slides and to help draft this post. It helped me pick out the main ideas quickly. The lesson made the same point I keep learning each week: check AI output against the source.